

Kuwait

 Oil has transformed Kuwait, a tiny desert country at the northern end of the Gulf, into one of the world's most prosperous nations. Iraq's invasion of Kuwait, in 1990, was quelled by a United Nations force after a brief war. Since its liberation, Kuwait has built a wall to separate its territory from Iraq.



Kuwait City

The country of Kuwait is named after its capital city, which was founded in the 18th century. Situated on the shores of a natural harbour, Kuwait City is modern, built on a grid pattern with many attractive houses. The country's affluence is reflected in its glittering skyscrapers.



KUWAIT FACTS

CAPITAL CITY	Kuwait City
AREA	17,820 sq km (6,880 sq miles)
POPULATION	2,000,000
MAIN LANGUAGES	Arabic, English
MAJOR RELIGION	Muslim
CURRENCY	Kuwaiti dinar

Free education

The revenue from the oil industry enables the Kuwaiti government to provide its children, both male and female, with free education, from nursery level to university. The Kuwaiti people have some of the world's highest salaries, pay no income tax, and receive free health care and social services.

United Arab Emirates

 The United Arab Emirates (UAE) is a federation of seven small states: Abu Dhabi, Ajman, Dubai, Fujairah, Ras al Khaimah, Sharjah, and Umm al Quaiwan. Each ruled by its own independent emir, or sheikh, they unite for international matters and to sell the oil that has made them rich.



Fishing

All the states bordering the Gulf have busy fishing fleets. In high summer they also send divers down to collect pearls from the pearl oysters. This industry has flourished for many hundreds of years.

Pearl develops from a grain of sand inside the shell.

Mina' Jabal 'Ali port

The UAE is one of the world's leading exporters of natural gas and oil, both of which leave the country via Mina' Jabal 'Ali port, the world's largest artificial harbour. Since less than three per cent of the UAE land can be cultivated, the port is also used to import food products.



UNITED ARAB EMIRATES FACTS

CAPITAL CITY	Abu Dhabi
AREA	83,600 sq km (32,278 sq miles)
POPULATION	2,400,000
MAIN LANGUAGES	Arabic, Farsi
MAJOR RELIGION	Muslim
CURRENCY	UAE dirham

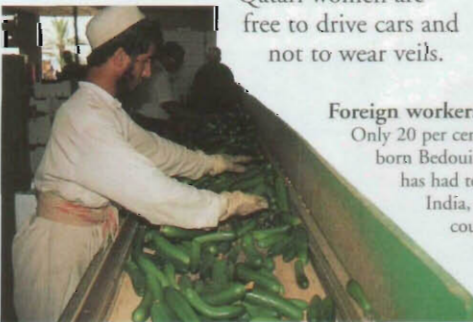
Tourism

Hot sun, sandy beaches, and duty-free shopping make the UAE an attractive winter holiday resort for visitors from Europe and Japan (summer is too hot for tourism). The federation is gradually building up its tourism. Other attractions include trips into the desert, luxury hotels, and traditional markets.

Qatar

 A small peninsula in the Persian Gulf, Qatar, like other Gulf States, depends on natural gas and oil for its wealth. Although most of the country is desert, Qatar grows most of its own food by tapping reserves of underground water.

Qatari women are free to drive cars and not to wear veils.



Foreign workers

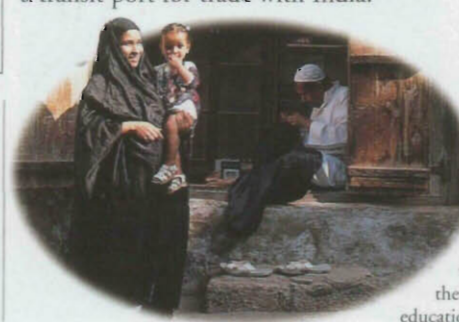
Only 20 per cent of the people are native-born Bedouin Qataris. The country has had to import workers from India, Asia, Iran, and other Arab countries to cope with the work produced by the oil industry. Almost 90 per cent of the population live in the capital, Doha.

QATAR FACTS

CAPITAL CITY	Doha
AREA	11,000 sq km (4,415 sq miles)
POPULATION	699,000
MAIN LANGUAGES	Arabic, Farsi
MAJOR RELIGION	Muslim
CURRENCY	Qatar riyal

Bahrain

 Three inhabited islands and 30 smaller ones make up the small country of Bahrain. The oil reserves that made it rich are now running low, but the country has plenty of natural gas. Bahrain has a long history, and 4,000 years ago was a transit port for trade with India.



BAHRAIN FACTS

CAPITAL CITY	Manama
AREA	680 sq km (263 sq miles)
POPULATION	617,000
MAIN LANGUAGES	Arabic, English
MAJOR RELIGIONS	Muslim, Christian
CURRENCY	Bahraini dinar

Women's role

Bahrain is the most liberal of the Gulf States. Although the people are Muslim, women are not obliged to wear the veil. They have equal access to education and many follow careers.